

Zhiyuan (Eric) Lin

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PROFILE

- Eric is a future Trainee Solicitor at Withers and a Juris Doctor candidate at The Chinese University of Hong Kong. A qualified PRC lawyer, he is building a career at the intersection of Chinese and international law. Eric has achieved academic excellence, winning awards such as the Freshfields Community Investment Award and the Linklaters Making Links Scholarship. He has also gained practical experience in capital markets, cross-border transactions, and dispute resolution at leading US, UK, and Chinese law firms.
- He is also an accomplished international debater and mooter. Eric has competed successfully against top universities such as Oxford, Duke, and LSE. He demonstrated strong leadership and entrepreneurial drive by transforming a student club with limited resources into a nationally ranked team, organizing an event that attracted over 500,000 viewers.

EDUCATION BACKGROUND & QUALIFICATIONS

The Chinese University of Hong Kong

09/2024-07/2026 (Expected)

Degree: *Juris Doctor* **Academic Standing:** GPA 3.647/4.0 (Ranked in the top 5% of the cohort)

- Honors:** Linklaters Making Links Scholarship; The Freshfields Community Investment Award; SCIA Scholarship; JD Bronze Scholarship for Academic Merit (2025-26)
- Awards:** Top 8 Global Best Teams and National First Runner-up of the FDI Moot
- Professional Qualification:** Postgraduate Certificate in Laws (PCLL) at CUHK (Admitted for 2026–2027, UGC-funded Place)

Jiangxi University of Finance and Economics (JUFE)

09/2020-07/2024

Degree: *Bachelor of Laws Major: Law and Forensic Accounting*

Academic Standing: GPA: 4.13/5.0 (91.28%) (Ranked in the top 2.5% of the cohort)

- Honors:** Excellent Graduate; University Scholarship (Top 1%); "Aofoi" Enterprise Scholarship (Top 1%)
2024 Outstanding Undergraduate Overseas Study Scholarship (Top 1%)
- Awards:** 1st National Prize in the 1st "LinkedIn Cup" Workplace New Force Debate Competition
Distinguished Oralist of Lee & Li Moot Court Competition
- Professional Qualification:** Legal Professional Qualification Examination of the PRC (PRC Bar)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Linklaters LLP | Hong Kong | Making Links Scholar & EDM Working Experience Student 02/2025-08/2025

Selected for Linklaters' talent program for students with exceptional academic excellence and resilience

- Engaged in a structured development curriculum comprising an internship, dedicated senior-level mentorship, and advanced workshops on core commercial practice areas and client communication skills
- Drafted FDDQ and MDDQ questionnaires for an offshore bond issuance based on the company's latest financial data and relevant news, focusing on abnormal financial data fluctuations and significant equity changes, administrative penalties
- Communicated with previous creditors regarding a new round of offshore issuance, and researched and organized clauses in the company's prior loan agreements that restricted refinancing

Withers LLP | Hong Kong | Summer Vacation Intern & Future Trainee Solicitor

06/2025-07/2025

Litigation & Arbitration and Private Client (Business) team

- Analyzed share transfer records and existing liabilities to assess the legal and financial risks of the assets and determine their suitability for holding within the trust structure
- Drafted a legal memorandum analyzing a shareholder dispute across Hong Kong and Singapore, identifying breaches of the Shareholders' Agreement, director's fiduciary duties, and grounds for unfair prejudice and criminal claims to devise a strategic litigation and settlement strategy
- Developed legal arguments for a High Court affirmation to oppose a summary judgment application, formulating defenses based on the unenforceability of the underlying credit agreement

Morgan Lewis & Bockius LLP | Hong Kong | Summer Intern (Vacation Scheme)

06/2025-06/2025

Mainly worked with the IPO, General Corporate, and Debt Capital Markets teams

- Supported an offshore debt issuance by preparing initial drafts of key sections (e.g., Risk Factors and Senior Management) and creating the detailed verification notes used for final financial due diligence
- Authored a comprehensive answer sheet for foreign clients, detailing taxation, tax refund, and profit distribution procedures in Mainland China and Hong Kong to ensure the compliance of their local operations
- Ensured the accuracy and clarity of an IPO prospectus in its final stages by meticulously proofreading and updating the “Definitions” and “Glossary of Technical Terms” during the high-pressure printer session

Zhong Lun Law Firm | Hong Kong & Shenzhen | Legal Intern

04/2024-07/2024

Foreign Direct Investment and Debt Capital Markets team

- Drafted arguments in an U.S. litigation for an expert witness report by interpreting non-prescriptive regulations to argue that the client’s disclosure was a mandatory legal obligation
- Supported a strategic cross-border investment by a German industrial leader into its key PRC supplier. Responsibilities included drafting initial versions of key ancillary documents (notably the call option and best price agreements) and proofreading the principal subscription agreement
- Drafted research memoranda advising international clients on PRC law, demonstrating broad advisory capabilities across capital markets (Panda Bond issuance) and data privacy (PIPL compliance)

Zhong Lun Law Firm | Chengdu | Legal Intern

11/2023-02/2024

PE/VC/M&A team

- Assessed the risk of triggering a mandatory general offer by analyzing whether a major shareholder retaining over 30% of voting rights post-divestment would be deemed “acting in concert” under Hong Kong Law
- Assessed a proposed IPO’s compliance with the CSRC’s new 2023 overseas listing regime, focusing on “look-through” diligence, filing thresholds, and negative list prohibitions
- Drafted key provisions for a share purchase agreement to mitigate specific risks identified in due diligence, including warranties covering ambiguous patent ownership and clauses governing pre-closing employments

Global Law Office | Beijing | Legal Intern

07/2023-09/2023

Capital Markets: Securitization & Derivatives team

- Drafted legal memoranda advising overseas investors on the PRC regulatory landscape for public M&A, analyzing key issues such as foreign ownership restrictions (Negative List), national security review requirements, and antitrust filing obligations
- Conducted due diligence on a bank’s credit asset portfolio to assess its eligibility as underlying assets for a proposed asset-backed security (ABS) transaction

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

33rd Willem C. Vis International Commercial Arbitration Moot | Team Member

09/2025-04/2026

- Quarterfinalist for Team Orals at both Vis Vienna and Vis East; received Honorable Mention of the Fali Nariman Award for Best Written Memorandum for Respondent
- Selected as oralist candidate; participated in oral training rounds with peer universities and intra-team practice sessions
- Researched the interpretation of dispute resolution clauses under Art. 8(2) and (3) CISG; analyzed disclosure requirements for Third-Party Funding (TPF) agreements under the SIAC Rules

FDI Moot (National & Globals) | Team Leader and Researcher

04/2025-11/2025

- Orchestrated the end-to-end legal strategy for a team of 8, managing all phases from case analysis and memorial drafting (ICSID Rules) to oral advocacy preparation
- Authored the team’s core arguments on novel questions of jurisdiction and merits, forming the foundation of the Claimant and Respondent memorials

JUFE Debate Team | Deputy Captain & Executive Consultant

09/2021-07/2024

- Led a strategic overhaul of the university’s debate team, securing its first institutional funding by presenting a successful business case to university leadership, elevating the team from unranked to 47th nationally

SKILLS & INTERESTS

- **Skills:** MS Office; Legal Research & Writing; Legal Databases (Westlaw, LexisNexis, etc.); AIGC
- **Language Proficiency:** Fluent English, Native Mandarin, Basic Conversation Cantonese
- **Interests:** Debate; Musicals; Singing; Mountaineering; Table Games